Aashish Sunar
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October 20, 2026

Hiring Team
Esri
Redlands, CA

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the ArcGIS Product Engineering Internship at Esri, alongside the Software Development Engineer Internship. Product engineering is the part of building software I keep returning to: using the product the way a customer will, finding where it gives a wrong answer, and writing it up so a developer can fix it the first time.

The clearest example is my newest project, GeoAssist Hazard Proximity, an MCP server that lets an AI assistant find the hospitals and schools closest to an active wildfire using Living Atlas layers and NASA's event feed. While testing it against the live hospital layer, I found that the `TRAUMA` field is free text, and Level I alone is written 16 different ways. An exact filter for `'LEVEL I'` found 98 open Level I hospitals and missed 142. The query did not fail. It returned a shorter list that looked complete, which is the kind of bug that reaches a customer because nothing flags it. I documented what I found, changed the server so the model sees every value of a coded field, and published a live map where anyone can reproduce it.

That project grew out of GeoAssist, a natural language explorer for ArcGIS Feature Services built on Esri's web components and the Calcite Design System, with keyboard navigation and ARIA live regions on top. At CGU's AI for Humanity Lab I build test tooling for a living: a TypeScript and Playwright tool that loads a live page and measures whether a required AI disclosure can actually be seen, rather than checking that the text exists in the source.

Much of what I know about users I learned on the phone. At Nepal Technical Service I answered support calls from shop owners, reproduced what they described, wrote it up as steps anyone could follow, and localized the platform for the Nepal market rather than translating the labels on a US product. At Soka University I tested a disaster alerting tool with office staff who had never used a map interface and redesigned it around how they worked.

I am finishing an MS in Information Systems and Technology at Claremont Graduate University in May 2027, and I can commit to a consecutive twelve week onsite internship starting that May or June. I live in Claremont, about 30 miles from Redlands, and would be glad to walk through any of this in person.

Thank you for your time.

Sincerely,
Aashish Sunar